

Summary Post

by [Abdulrahman Alhashmi](#) - Tuesday, 4 November 2025, 9:13 PM

From my first post and others' replies, a shared view stands out: dark patterns harm user choice, public well-being, and job standards. When viewed through the ACM Code, the violations hit key points—support the public good (1.1), prevent harm (1.2), stay honest and reliable (1.3), and check effects before launch (2.5). Leaders must fight bad habits and set up fair systems too (3.1, 3.3). The BCS Code matches this: serve public needs, keep skills and honesty strong, and protect privacy. By making tricky defaults common, designers weaken these basics and break trust.

The risks in law and society run deep. UK rules on consumer rights block false tricks, and UK GDPR calls for fair play, clear info, and real, targeted agreement—rules broken by pre-checked boxes, switches that bury cheap options, and hard paths to skip. Studies prove these tricks cut smart choices and build doubt, leading to harm and tired consent. Proof now pushes us past talk to real fixes in design.

Experts must step up. They should:

- drop forced defaults and uneven hurdles;
- use clear, undoable opt-ins with simple explanations;
- sign up trials where goals cover user good, beyond just sales;
- do Data Protection Impact Assessments and note choices;
- add outside checks on designs and ways to report issues, with boss oversight.

This view links morals to daily work. It shifts focus from quick wins to lasting faith. It sees control: screen choices guide picks and spread dangers. The true measure skips “does it sell” for “is it just, easy to grasp, and okay for users, rules, and team?” By that bar, this design falls short. The fix is simple: rebuild for understanding, agreement, and respect, then prove gains via checks, feedback logs, and user-focused results. That marks true pro work in tech.

References

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